

UPRIGHT

1. Passage anchor

> “In their eyes, a lesson should look like students **sitting upright**, copying notes and preparing for tests.”

Passage meaning

upright = with the body held straight and vertical rather than leaning, bending, or lying down
挺直地；坐直；身體直立的

Here, **sitting upright** means students are sitting with their backs and bodies straight.

Practice

1. Please **sit upright** in your chair.
請在椅子上**坐直**。
2. He remained **upright** despite feeling tired.
雖然很累，他仍保持**身體挺直**。

Core meanings of UPRIGHT

2. upright — vertical / straight up

As an adjective:

= positioned vertically rather than horizontally, tilted, or lying down
直立的；豎直的

Examples

1. Keep the bottle **upright**.
把瓶子保持**直立**。
2. The box must remain **upright** during transport.
運送期間，箱子必須保持**豎直**。

This is the central physical sense.

3. upright — body posture

= having the body or back straight and vertical

****挺直的；直立的****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. She sat ****upright**** at the desk.

她在書桌前****挺直身子坐著****。

2. Try to maintain an ****upright posture****.

嘗試保持****挺直的姿勢****。

4. upright posture

= body position in which the head and torso are held vertically

****直立姿勢；挺直的姿勢****

Examples

1. Good chairs can support an ****upright posture****.

好的椅子可以幫助保持****挺直坐姿****。

2. He returned slowly to an ****upright position****.

他慢慢恢復到****直立姿勢****。

Standing rather than lying down

5. upright — standing / not fallen

= remaining vertical and not lying, leaning, or falling over

****直立著的；沒有倒下的****

Examples

1. Only one tree remained ****upright**** after the storm.

暴風雨後只剩一棵樹仍然****直立著****。

2. The damaged fence was barely ****upright****.

損壞的圍欄勉強還****立著****。

6. keep / remain upright

= continue standing or staying vertical

保持直立；沒有倒下

Examples

1. The structure could no longer remain **upright**.

那個結構已無法繼續**直立**。

2. He struggled to keep himself **upright**.

他努力讓自己**保持站穩**。

Adverb-like use

7. sit / stand upright

= sit or stand with the body straight

挺直地坐 / 站

Examples

1. She **stood upright** and took a deep breath.

她**挺直身子站著**，深吸了一口氣。

2. The students were told to **sit upright**.

學生被要求**坐直**。

Although **upright** is formally an adjective/adverb in different analyses, learners can treat this construction functionally as **「挺直地」**.

Moral character

8. upright — morally honest

= honest, honorable, and guided by strong moral principles

正直的；品行端正的

Examples

1. He was known as an **upright man**.

他以為人**正直**而聞名。

2. She is an **upright and principled person**.

她是一個**正直而有原則**的人。

This is the major figurative sense.

The metaphor is:

physically straight → morally straight

9. upright citizen / person

= morally respectable and honest person

正直的人；守法正派的公民

Examples

1. He was regarded as an **upright citizen**.

他被視為一名**正直的公民**。

2. Everyone trusted her because she was honest and **upright**.

大家都信任她，因為她誠實而且**正直**。

UPRIGHTNESS

10. uprightness — physical vertical position

= condition of being vertical or straight

直立；挺直狀態

Examples

1. The frame's **uprightness** was checked carefully.

工作人員仔細檢查框架是否保持**垂直**。

This physical noun sense exists but is less common than simply saying **vertical position/alignment**.

11. uprightness — moral honesty

= quality of being morally honest and principled

****正直；品行端正****

Examples

1. He was respected for his ****uprightness****.
他因自己的****正直品格****而受到尊敬。
2. Her honesty and ****uprightness**** earned people's trust.
她的誠實與****正直****贏得了大家的信任。

This is a useful formal family form.

UPRIGHTLY

12. uprightly

Formal/rare:

= in an honest and morally correct manner

****正直地；堂堂正正地****

Examples

1. He tried to live ****uprightly****.
他努力****正直地生活****。
2. She acted ****uprightly**** even under pressure.
即使受到壓力，她仍****秉持正直行事****。

Modern everyday English usually prefers:

- * honestly
- * ethically
- * with integrity

So ****uprightly**** is lower priority.

Upright piano

13. upright piano

= piano whose strings and frame are arranged vertically, giving it a tall compact shape

****直立式鋼琴；立式鋼琴****

Examples

1. They have an ****upright piano**** in the living room.
他們客廳裡有一部****直立式鋼琴****。
2. An ****upright piano**** takes up less floor space than a grand piano.
****立式鋼琴****比三角鋼琴佔用較少地面空間。

Major lexicalized object sense.

14. an upright — piano

As a noun, especially in music contexts:

= an upright piano

****立式鋼琴****

Examples

1. The studio contains a grand piano and an ****upright****.
錄音室裡有一部三角鋼琴和一部****立式鋼琴****。
2. She practises on an old ****upright****.
她用一部舊****立式鋼琴****練習。

Context is essential.

Upright bass

15. upright bass

= large string instrument played vertically; double bass

****低音大提琴；直立低音提琴****

Examples

1. He plays ****upright bass**** in a jazz group.

他在爵士樂團裡演奏**低音大提琴**。

2. The **upright bass** stood beside the piano.

低音大提琴放在鋼琴旁邊。

Here **upright** describes the instrument's playing/physical orientation.

Furniture / appliances

16. upright freezer

= freezer designed as a tall vertical cabinet rather than a horizontal chest

直立式冰櫃；立式冷凍櫃

Examples

1. They bought an **upright freezer** for the kitchen.

他們為廚房買了一部**直立式冷凍櫃**。

2. An **upright freezer** is easier to organize than a chest freezer.

立式冰櫃通常比臥式冰櫃更容易整理。

This remains a transparent physical-orientation use rather than a new independent sense.

17. upright vacuum

= vacuum cleaner with its main body arranged vertically

直立式吸塵器

Examples

1. She uses an **upright vacuum** on the carpet.

她用**直立式吸塵器**清潔地毯。

Again, this is a transparent extension of **vertical**.

Structural noun

18. upright — vertical structural member

As a noun:

= vertical post, support, beam, or frame member

****立柱；直立支架****

Examples

1. The horizontal beam was fixed between two ****uprights****.
橫樑固定在兩根****立柱****之間。
2. One of the wooden ****uprights**** was damaged.
其中一根木製****立柱****受損。

Major technical/construction noun sense.

Sports frame

19. upright — vertical goalpost

In some sports:

= one of the vertical posts forming a goal

****球門立柱****

Examples

1. The ball struck the ****upright****.
球擊中了****球門立柱****。
2. The shot passed just outside the left ****upright****.
射門僅僅偏出左側****門柱****。

Especially associated with football/rugby contexts.

Keep something upright

20. keep something upright

= maintain something in a vertical position

****使某物保持直立****

Examples

1. Use the support to **keep the plant upright**.
用支架讓植物**保持直立**。

2. The frame keeps the bottle **upright**.
那個框架使瓶子**保持直立**。

Set something upright

21. set something upright

= place something into a vertical position
把某物扶正 / 豎起

Examples

1. He picked up the chair and **set it upright**.
他把椅子撿起來並**扶正**。

2. They **set the sign upright** again.
他們把招牌重新**豎起來**。

Return to an upright position

22. return to an upright position

= move from lying, bending, or leaning to a straight vertical position
恢復直立姿勢；坐 / 站直

Examples

1. Slowly **return to an upright position**.
慢慢**恢復直立姿勢**。

2. He needed help to get back **upright**.
他需要別人幫助才能重新**站直 / 坐直**。

High-value contrasts

23. upright vs straight

****straight****

= not curved, bent, or crooked

****直的****

****upright****

= vertical or held vertically

****直立的****

Compare:

> a straight line

> 一條直線

> an upright post

> 一根直立柱

Something can be ****straight**** without being ****upright****.

A pencil lying flat can still be straight.

24. upright vs vertical

****vertical****

= technical/geometrical opposite of horizontal

****垂直的****

****upright****

= standing normally on its base, or body held straight

****直立的 ; 挺直的****

Compare:

> vertical axis

> 垂直軸

> sit upright

> 坐直

****Upright**** is generally more natural for posture.

25. upright vs erect

****erect****

= standing straight upright; often formal, anatomical, botanical, or technical

****直立的 ; 挺立的****

****upright****

= more neutral everyday word for vertical body/object position

Compare:

> sit upright

> 坐直

> an erect stem

> 直立莖

26. upright vs standing

****standing****

= in a standing position rather than sitting/lying

****站立的****

****upright****

= describes vertical alignment, whether the person is sitting or standing

Therefore:

> sit upright

is perfectly natural.

You cannot replace it with:

>  sit standing

27. upright vs honest

****honest****

= truthful; not lying or cheating

****誠實的****

****upright****

= broader moral character: honorable, principled, morally respectable

****正直的****

Compare:

> an honest answer

> 誠實的回答

> an upright person

> 正直的人

28. upright vs righteous

****righteous****

= morally right or believing oneself to be morally right; sometimes religious or negative in tone

****正義的；正直的；自以為正義的****

****upright****

= generally neutral/formal praise for moral integrity

****正直的；品行端正的****

Meaning map

The central physical concept of ****upright**** is:

****straight upward in a vertical position****

From this develop several branches.

A. Posture

Passage

sit upright

→ ****坐直 / 挺直身子****

Body

stand upright

→ ****挺直站立****

B. Objects

Bottle

keep it upright
→ **保持直立**

Structure

upright post
→ **直立柱**

Sport

the upright
→ **球門立柱**

C. Objects designed vertically

Music

upright piano
→ **立式鋼琴**

Appliances

upright freezer
→ **直立式冷凍櫃**

D. Morality

The physical metaphor:

straight rather than crooked

develops into:

Person

upright person
→ **正直的人**

Quality

uprightness

→ ****正直品格****

So the semantic progression is very natural:

****physically straight → morally straight****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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upright — vertical	垂直站立、不平放或傾斜的；直立的
upright — posture	身體 / 背部挺直、不彎腰或斜靠的
sit upright	挺直身體坐著；坐直
stand upright	挺直身體站立
upright posture	身體保持垂直挺直的姿勢 / 坐姿
remain/keep upright	保持直立、不倒下
upright — moral	品格正直、誠實、有原則的
upright person/citizen	品行端正、值得尊敬的人 / 公民
uprightness — moral	正直、品行端正的品質
uprightly	正式 / 較少用：正直地、合乎道德地
upright piano	琴弦及琴體主要垂直排列的立式鋼琴
an upright — piano	音樂語境：一部立式鋼琴
upright bass	直立演奏的大型低音弦樂器；低音大提琴
upright freezer	櫃式垂直設計的立式冷凍櫃
upright — structural noun	建築 / 框架中的垂直立柱或支架
upright — goalpost	球門兩側的垂直立柱 / 門柱
keep something upright	使某物維持垂直站立狀態
set something upright	把倒下 / 橫放的東西扶正、豎起
return to an upright position	從躺、彎或傾斜狀態恢復直立姿勢

Passage recap

> “In their eyes, a lesson should look like students ****sitting upright****, copying notes and preparing for tests.”

Here:

****upright**** = ****with the upper body and back held straight in a vertical position****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **坐直**

* **挺直身子**

* **保持端正坐姿**

Natural contextual translation:

在他們眼中，課堂就應該是學生端端正正地坐著、抄筆記和準備測驗。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

upright

= **straight and vertical rather than bent, leaning, or lying down**

直立的；挺直的

In the exact phrase:

> **sit upright**

> → **坐直；挺直身子坐著**

The biggest learner splits are:

> **keep the bottle upright**

> → **讓瓶子**保持直立**

> **upright post**

> → **立柱**

> **upright piano**

> → **立式鋼琴**

> **the ball hit the upright**

> → **球擊中**球門立柱**

and figuratively:

> **an upright person**

> → **正直的人**

That last development is especially useful: English metaphorically treats moral goodness as **straightness** rather than crookedness.

So in this passage, **upright** is entirely physical: it describes the stereotypical image of students

****sitting straight and formally at their desks****, which the writer then contrasts with more active drama-based learning.